

**HEN GENERAL**

ELECTRIC launched its legendary Crotonville Leadership Centre in

1956, it became a global symbol of corporate learning. For decades, it shaped some of the world's most influential CEOs. But in 2024, when GE split and the centre closed, it marked not just the end of an era but the beginning of a new one with leadership learning moving beyond classrooms and case studies into a world defined by AI, geopolitical flux, and generational diversity.

The new business landscape demands more than credentials; it calls for adaptability, empathy, and digital fluency.

As B-schools design immersive, shorter programmes and corporations reimagine in-house academies, the real question is: who can nurture the most agile, future-ready leaders capable of leading through change, not just managing it?

India faces a unique dual challenge serving first-generation entrepreneurs building global enterprises from scratch, alongside third-generation family business leaders navigating succession.

LEADERSHIP PARADOX

Many Indian entrepreneurs have scaled up through instinct and relationship networks. Now, they seek frameworks to institutionalise decision-making and governance

TRAINING THE LEADERS

B-SCHOOLS ARE MAKING EXECUTIVE MBAs FLEXIBLE, PERSONALISED AND TECHNOLOGY-DRIVEN

BY MAMTA SHARMA

to ensure continuity beyond the founders charisma.

"Executive education in India must bridge intuition with structure—helping leaders formalise what has so far been instinctive," says Pallavi Jha, Chairperson and Managing Director, Walchand PeopleFirst Ltd and Dale Carnegie Training India.

That shift is visible in how business schools are evolving. "Over the next five years, programmes for working professionals must move beyond knowledge and skills to become catalysts for applied strategic action," says Sunill Sood, Executive

Director—Executive Education & Digital Learning, Indian School of Business (ISB).

He adds that tomorrow's differentiators won't only be technical expertise but strategic thinking, harnessing technology, prioritising ESG, and leading with empathy.

Vanita Bhoola, Assistant Dean-EMBA & Executive Education, SP Jain School of Global Management, notes: "The pace of technological disruption requires programmes to be flexible, personalised and technology-driven. The emphasis is on immersive learning experiences."

REWRITING LEADERSHIP LEARNING

1 **Executive education is shifting from credentials to capabilities focusing on adaptability, empathy and real-world problem-solving over theory and titles**

2 **Indian leaders are evolving from instinct-led entrepreneurship to structured, institutional leadership, blending agility with governance and long-term vision**